

Autopilot on Volkswagen cars

Volkswagen has proposed a new autopilot technology for its cars using a range of technologies from lasers to ultrasonic sensors.

Facebook bars Cadbury

Facebook bars the India pages of Cadbury and F&M citing violations of their laws by posting contests on their walls.

coupons or freebies for local businesses in the vicinity of your recent visit.

► **Mobile socialising:** The proliferation of smartphones and their host of applications, affordable data plans, inbuilt web browsers and mobile-ready web sites are reasons for why you see more of your friends posting updates from their BlackBerrys and iPhones.

► **Recruitment, background checks, and freelancing:** Increasingly, companies are using these networks to find the most suitable candidates, and are directly contacting these passive applicants with unadvertised job opportunities, bypassing costly recruitment companies. With 29 per cent of the global workforce already employing this method, we'll soon have social media replacing HR and recruitment firms.

► **Marketing activities of companies:** An increasing number of Indian companies are using social media as an effective business tool, with 83 per cent firms in the country agreeing that without social media activity, marketing strategies cannot be successful, according to a survey by Regus. The global figure for the same is 74 per cent of companies. The last year has seen a rise in Indian companies using social networks, blogs, microblogs and forums to win new business. Internationally even, the rising awareness among businesses has seen social networking evolve from a nice-to-have to a necessity. Two-fifths (39 per cent) of firms globally and almost half in India (49 per cent) devote up to 20 per cent of their marketing budget to business social networking activity, as per the survey. Twitter, the ninth most popular site in the world according to three-month Alexa traffic rankings, is one of the most frequented site for this purpose.

Back to the future

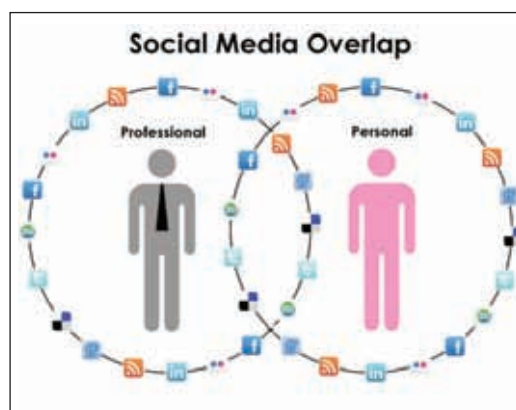
By 2014, social networking services will replace e-mail as the primary vehicle for interpersonal communications for 20 per cent of business users. "The rigid distinction between email and social networks will erode. Email will take on many social attributes, such as contact brokering while social networks will develop richer email capabilities," according to



Future mobile web social media

Matt Cain, research vice president at Gartner. He added, "While email is already almost fully penetrated in the corporate space, we expect to see steep growth rates for sales of premises – and cloud-based social networking services."

Ten years from now, mobiles (or portable devices) will be the world's primary connection tool to the internet. A recent study by Strategy Analytics, a global research and consulting firm indicates that the number of people using their cell phones to access the web has quadrupled over the past four years. A large portion of this increased online time is spent on social media web sites. As the number of phones in the world climbs to three billion, Gartner expects more users to spend significant time on the collaborative tools on these devices. In fact, for some parts of the world, these apps are expected to be the first or only applications they've ever used. These tools will enable users to



Personal vs. professional networking

THREE USEFUL LINKEDIN FEATURES

Improve your Google PageRank : Customise your LinkedIn profile URL. To do this, go to your "Edit Profile" page. Use a combination of your first name and last name. For example, <http://in.linkedin.com/in/firstname>. This way, not only will your visibility on web searches increase, but it also makes it easier to link to your profile in your email signature or on your business card.

Map your network : InMaps helps you to map your network with an interactive visual representation. It represents a map of your professional universe that helps you see how all your connections are related to each other. It's a great way to understand the relationships between you and your entire set of LinkedIn connections. You can better leverage your professional network to help pass along job opportunities, seek professional advice, gather insights and more. Your InMap can also be displayed on your profile enabling the members in your network to see the entire set of connections.

Company Pages : LinkedIn company pages help bring a brand to life by showcasing standout products and services to millions of professionals turning to its networks for help in making critical business decisions every day. Get to know more about the company by looking at the unique data from the LinkedIn network. Company pages also give key statistics on the demographics of the company's current employees, including your connections. Statistics of these employees include years of experience, educational degrees acquired, etc.

handle far more conversations within a given amount of time than their desktop PCs or laptops mostly due to ease of use. As iPhone impacted user interface design on the desktop, the experience in mobile phone collaboration will dramatically affect PC applications, many of which are derivatives of decades-old platforms.

Another trend expected to be seen in the future is being paid to use professional networks. With brands steadily moving into the social media space, a day will soon come when brands will allow you to be reimbursed or paid for promoting their brands for simply using their space.

Going forward, the lines between business networking and personal networking will be so blurry that it will be difficult to tell them apart. **[4]**